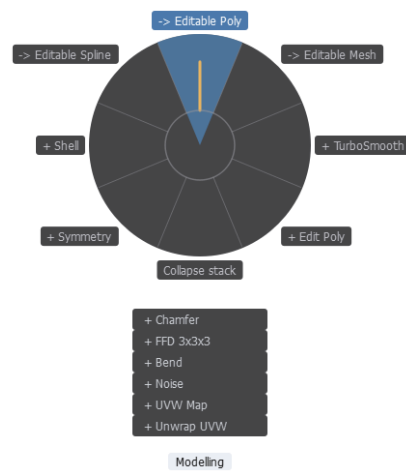


# MarkingForge

QuickStart - the short version

3DS MAX 2027 · VERSION 1.5.30 · ABOUT 15 MINUTES



---

Only what you need to start: 8 short lessons. Everything else is in the full **QuickStart** and the **Reference - MarkingForge > Documentation** opens them.

## Before you start

---

- 1 Look at the 3ds Max menu bar. You should see a **MarkingForge** menu.
- 2 Open **MarkingForge > Set up standard shortcuts...** It gives each dial its key, or says they already have one.

### A dial is a round menu under a key

Hold

**Alt+1**

: eight commands appear around the mouse.

### Aim, do not read

Move towards a command and let go of the key. Your hand learns the direction.

### Nothing can go wrong

Let go in the middle, or press Esc: nothing runs.  
Ctrl+Z undoes any command.

## PART 1

# Using the dials

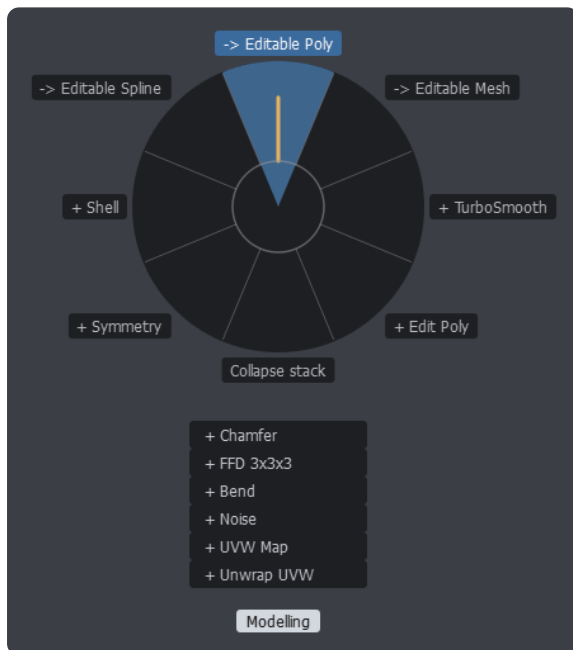
Five lessons. Open an empty scene and try each step.

1

### Your first gesture

2 min

- 1 Mouse over a viewport. Hold **Alt+4** - the Create dial.
- 2 Move up to **Box** and let go. Drag a box in the viewport.
- 3 Click the box. Hold **Alt+1**, move up to **-> Editable Poly**, let go.



Alt+1, moved up: the box becomes an Editable Poly.

#### RESULT

Two gestures, no menus.

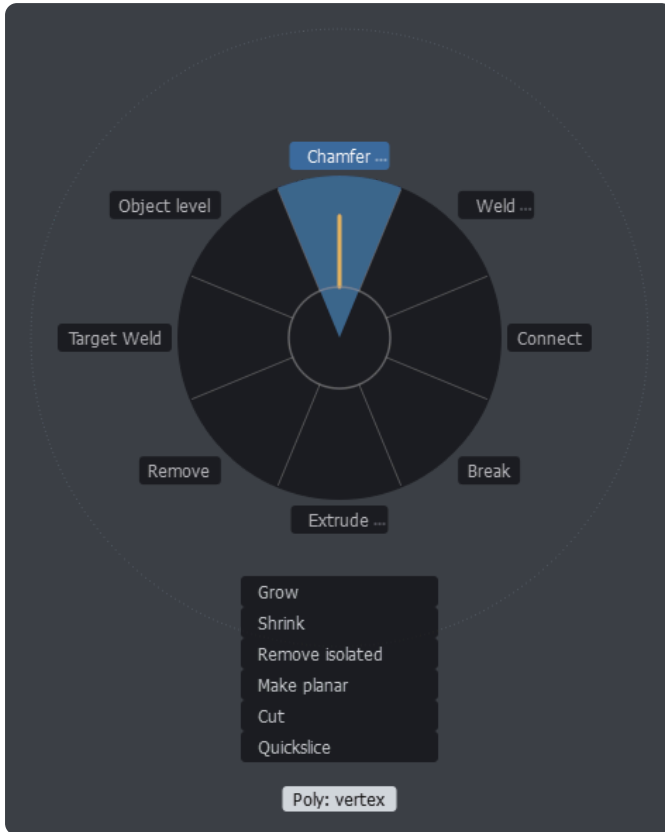
2

### The dial changes with your work

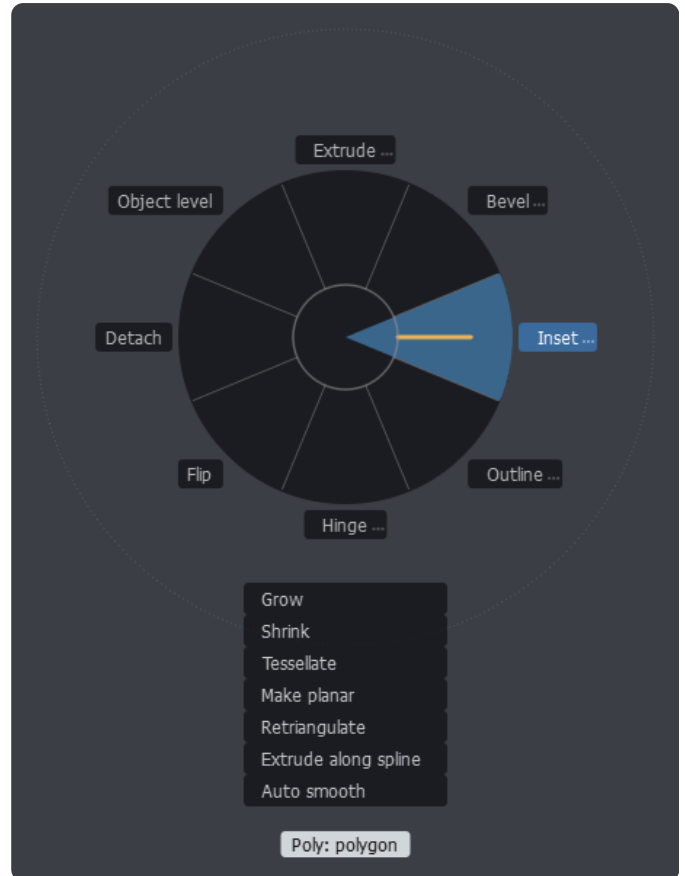
2 min

- 1 Press **1** (vertices). Hold **Alt+1**: now it shows vertex tools - Chamfer, Weld, Connect...
- 2 Press **4** (polygons). Hold **Alt+1**: Inset, Extrude, Bevel...

3 Move up-left (**Object level**) to go back to the whole object.



Vertices.



Polygons.

3

### Flick - the fast way

2 min

Press the key and move **at the same moment**, then let go. The command runs and the dial does not even show. Try each one a few times:

| Press, then move | What happens                |
|------------------|-----------------------------|
| Ctrl+Alt+7, up   | Zoom to see everything      |
| Alt+3, up / down | Select all / select nothing |
| Ctrl+Alt+1, up   | Move tool                   |
| Alt+7, up        | Undo one step               |

4

### Near or far: the dotted circle

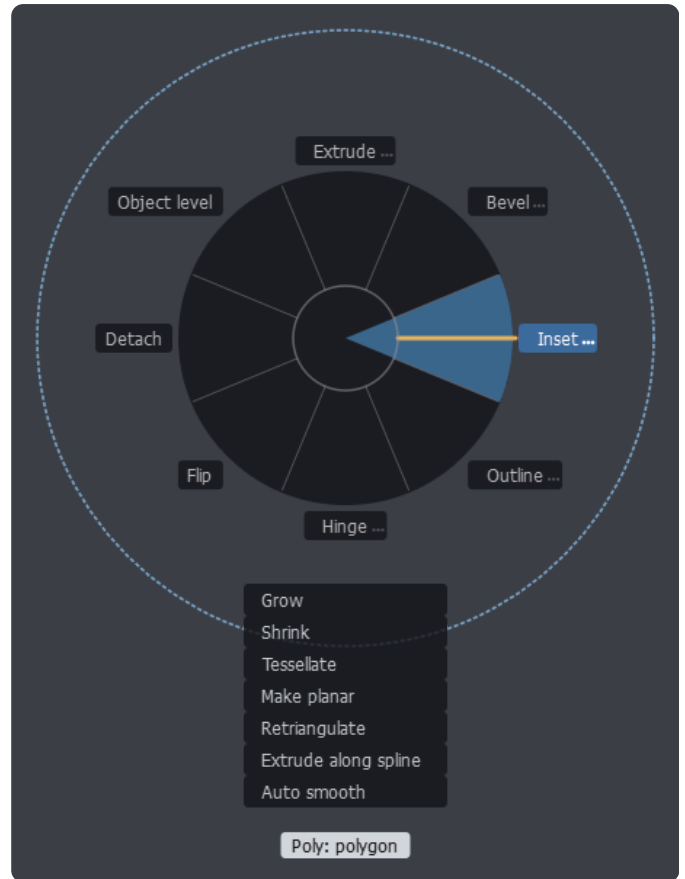
2 min

Commands with three dots (Chamfer..., Inset...) have a settings window.

- Let go **near** the dial: the command starts at once - drag in the viewport to set it.
- Let go **past the dotted circle** (it lights up): the settings window opens.



Near: Inset starts at once.



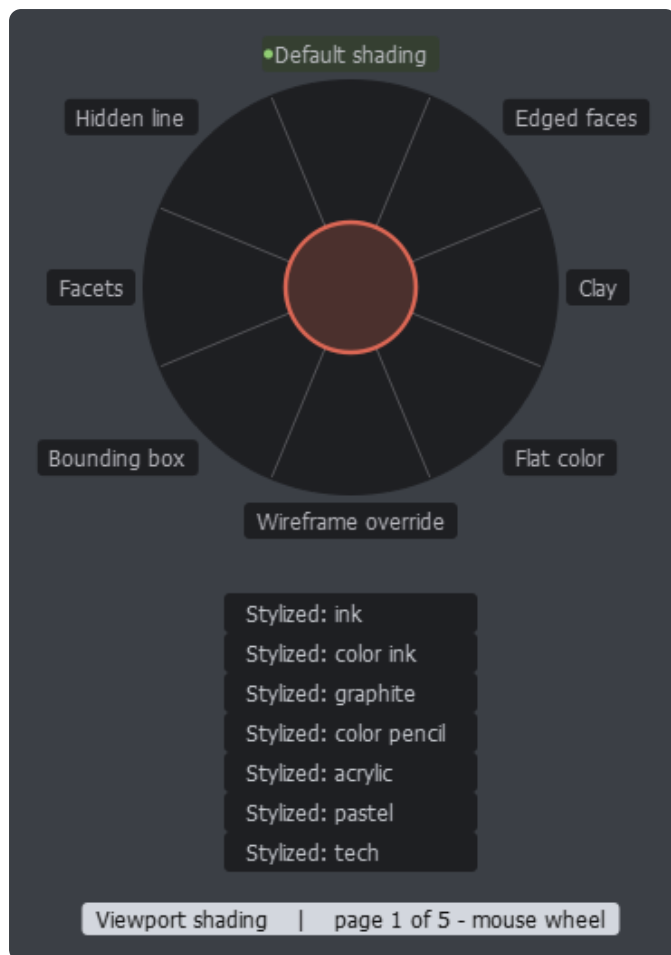
Past the circle: Inset's window.

## 5

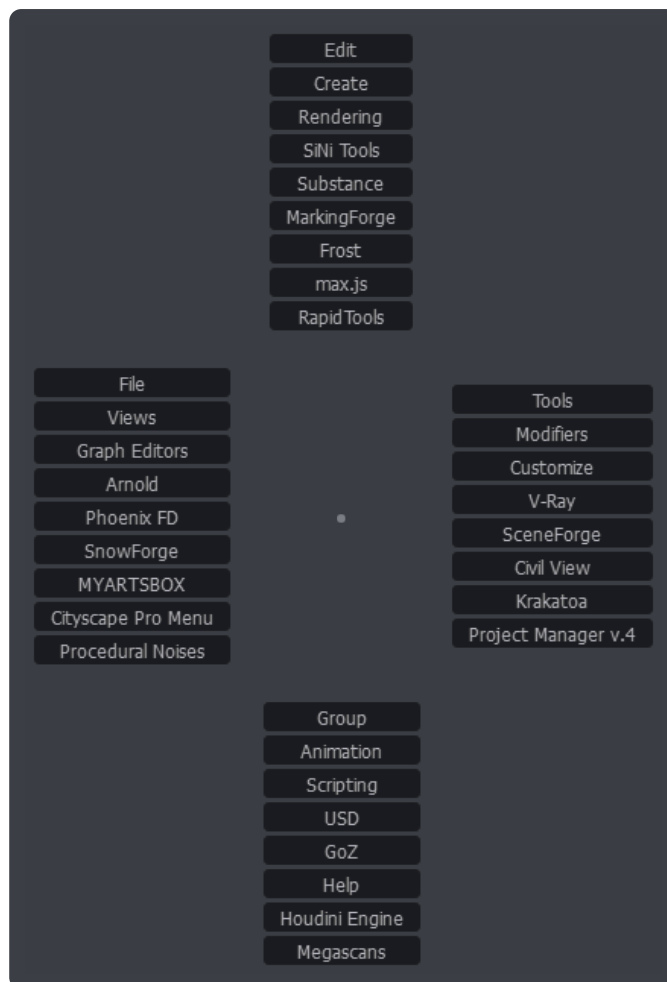
### Pages, the hotbox and undo

2 min

- 1 Hold **Alt+5**: how the viewport looks. Keep holding and **turn the mouse wheel** - more pages (lights, what is shown, views).
- 2 Turn the wheel one step the other way: the **hotbox** - every 3ds Max menu as tiles. Esc closes it.
- 3 Hold **Alt+7**: your last steps by name. Pick one to undo back to it.



Alt+5 - the viewport.



Alt+5, wheel - the hotbox.

# Which key is which

The number (1-8) is the place; **Alt**, **Ctrl+Alt** or **Shift+Alt** is the row.

| Key          | Dial             | Key               | Dial               | Key                | Dial             |
|--------------|------------------|-------------------|--------------------|--------------------|------------------|
| <b>Alt+1</b> | Modelling        | <b>Ctrl+Alt+1</b> | Transform          | <b>Shift+Alt+1</b> | Viewport display |
| <b>Alt+2</b> | Modifiers        | <b>Ctrl+Alt+2</b> | Align and pivot    | <b>Shift+Alt+2</b> | Selection sets   |
| <b>Alt+3</b> | Selection        | <b>Ctrl+Alt+3</b> | Lights and cameras | <b>Shift+Alt+3</b> | Materials        |
| <b>Alt+4</b> | Create           | <b>Ctrl+Alt+4</b> | UV mapping         | <b>Shift+Alt+4</b> | Render           |
| <b>Alt+5</b> | Viewport shading | <b>Ctrl+Alt+5</b> | Snaps and grid     | <b>Shift+Alt+5</b> | Animation        |
| <b>Alt+6</b> | Modifier stack   | <b>Ctrl+Alt+6</b> | Show and hide      | <b>Shift+Alt+6</b> | Scene            |
| <b>Alt+7</b> | Undo             | <b>Ctrl+Alt+7</b> | View               | <b>Shift+Alt+7</b> | Tools and setup  |
| <b>Alt+8</b> | Recent commands  | <b>Ctrl+Alt+8</b> | Viewports          | <b>Shift+Alt+8</b> | File             |

Print your own list: **MarkingForge > Dial cheat sheet (HTML + PDF)...** - keep it next to the keyboard for the first week.

## PART 2

# Changing the dials

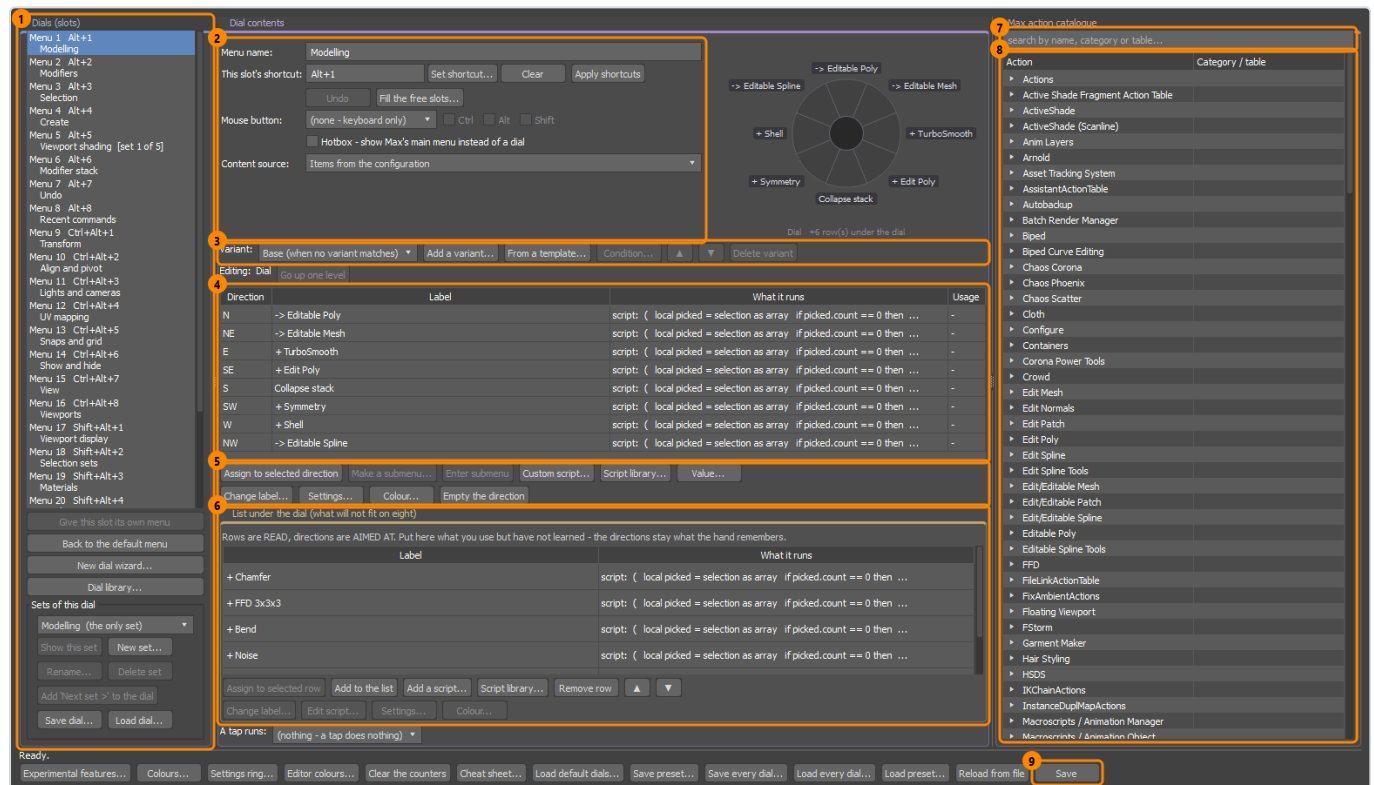
Three lessons. Nothing changes until you press **Save**.

6

## Open the editor

1 min

MarkingForge > Menu editor...



The menu editor.

1. The 24 dials - click one to change it.
2. Its name, key and mouse button.
3. Versions of the dial for other situations (see the full QuickStart).
4. The eight directions.
5. Buttons for the selected direction.
6. Extra rows under the dial.
7. Search box.
8. Every 3ds Max command.
9. Save.

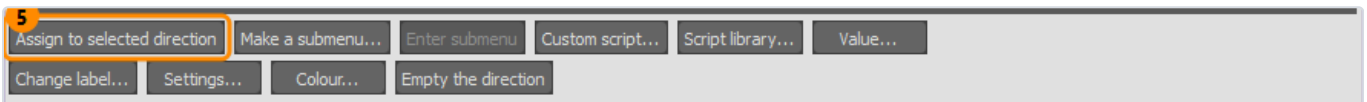
## 7

## Put your own command on a dial

3 min

Example: on the File dial (Shift+Alt+8), put **Export Selected** down-right.

- 1 Click **Menu 24** in the list of dials.
- 2 Type `Export Selected` in the search box and click the command.
- 3 Click the **SE** row in the directions table.
- 4 Press **Assign to selected direction** under the table (or double-click the command).
- 5 Press **Save**.



The button under the directions table.

| Direction | Label              | What it runs                    | Usage |
|-----------|--------------------|---------------------------------|-------|
| N         | Save               | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| NE        | Save as...         | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| E         | Save incremental   | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| SE        | Export Selected... | action: Main UI (name from Max) | -     |
| S         | Open...            | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| SW        | Import...          | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| W         | Merge...           | action: Main UI                 | -     |
| NW        | Hold               | action: Main UI                 | -     |

SE now runs Export Selected.

## TRY IT

Hold Shift+Alt+8 over a viewport: down-right is Export Selected.

## 8

## Save, start again, share

2 min

| Button (bottom of the editor)          | What it does                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Save</b>                            | Your dials work at once.                                                          |
| <b>Reload from file</b>                | Throws away what you have not saved.                                              |
| <b>Load default dials...</b>           | The dials MarkingForge came with. Tick <i>Replace...</i> to get all of them back. |
| <b>Save preset... / Load preset...</b> | Your whole layout in one file - to keep or share.                                 |

## If something goes wrong

---

| What happens                                  | What to do                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Holding the key does nothing                  | <b>MarkingForge &gt; Set up standard shortcuts...</b>                 |
| I changed something, but the dial is the same | Press <b>Save</b> in the editor.                                      |
| I want the original dials back                | Editor: <b>Load default dials...</b> , tick <i>Replace...</i> , Save. |
| Where is the hotbox?                          | Hold Alt+5 and turn the mouse wheel one step away from you.           |
| A caption is red                              | That command is not in this 3ds Max. Put another one there.           |

**Want more?** The full QuickStart shows versions of a dial for each situation, scripts, number sliders, colours, more pages on one key and the dial library.

# Support, bug reports and feature requests

|         |                                                                                                                               |
|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ISSUES  | <a href="https://github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues">github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues</a>               |
| ROADMAP | <a href="https://trello.com/b/7gJVqG8Y/markingforge-features-roadmap">trello.com/b/7gJVqG8Y/markingforge-features-roadmap</a> |
| E-MAIL  | <a href="mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com">forgeplugins@gmail.com</a>                                                            |
| WEB     | <a href="https://forgeplugins.tech">https://forgeplugins.tech</a> (forgeplugins.tech - more plugins by the author)            |

**Bug reports and feature requests** are best opened as issues on GitHub - the forms there ask for exactly what is needed, and you can follow the fix. Questions, and anything you would rather not post publicly (licence, purchase), go to the e-mail address. Every message is read.

## Reporting a bug

- 1 In 3ds Max choose **MarkingForge > Report a bug...** - it copies your 3ds Max version, MarkingForge version, configuration summary and start-up log to the clipboard. It works even when the plugin did not load.
- 2 Open [github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues](https://github.com/Forge-Plugins/MarkingForge/issues) and pick **Bug report** - or write an e-mail to [forgeplugins@gmail.com](mailto:forgeplugins@gmail.com) instead. Both are links in the window that opens (since 1.5.20), one click each.
- 3 Say what you did, what you expected and what happened instead, then paste the details with **Ctrl+V**.
- 4 Add a screenshot if you can. When the problem is in one dial, attach a preset of it (editor > **Save preset...**).

## Suggesting a feature

Open an issue with the **Feature request** form, choose **MarkingForge > Suggest a feature...**, or simply write. Describe what you would like to do and how you do it today - a concrete example from your work says more than a list of wishes. Ideas for new built-in dials, commands and options are all welcome. What is already planned and in progress is on the **Roadmap** above - **MarkingForge > Roadmap (Trello)** opens it too.

Nothing is sent by the plugin itself: the details go to the clipboard and your own e-mail program, so you see everything that leaves your computer. MarkingForge has no network access.